

SEVEN HABITS

PHOTOGRAPH: 01-DESK-MORNING.JPG

Seven small habits that make the tools actually work

None of them is clever. All seven are the difference
between an answer you rewrite and one you send.

(01)

attach the real file, not a description of it

The tidied version you paste in is already an interpretation. Give it the messy original and the mess becomes information.

(02)

name the reader before you name the task

"For a finance director with five minutes" changes the answer more than any clever wording you can add afterwards.

(03)

say what to do when the answer is not in there

Ask it to write [GAP] or [CHECK] where your notes run out. Asked to mark its guesses, it marks them.

(04)

ask for the questions, not the summary

A summary tells you what a document says. Ten hard questions tell you what it costs you. Only one of those is worth ten minutes.

(05)

say out loud that the numbers must not move

Keep every figure and date exactly as written. It is one sentence and it removes the failure that matters most.

(06)

hand it the template you already use

Your own headings, your own order. Starting from your structure beats any first draft written from nothing.

(07)

read the first answer as a draft, not a verdict

The second attempt is where the work is. People who get nothing out of these tools almost always stopped after one.

THE LONG VERSION

Twenty-five prompts, written out in full

Each one gives the task in plain words, the prompt itself, what to attach, and what a good answer looks like. Free, no email, no form.

aiforcompanies.co.uk/prompts

Written for UK teams. None of them needs personal data to work; where a task touches people, the prompt asks for roles and situations, not names.